

AFL Data Foundations

1. Data Dictionary

Column	Meaning
team_name	Name of the team
opponent	Name of the opponent team
match_date	Date the match was played
year	Year of the match
result	Match result: W (Win), L (Loss), D (Draw)
team_score	Score made by the team in the match
win_streak	Number of previous consecutive wins by the team
last_5_avg_score	Average score from the team’s last 5 matches
head_to_head_wins	Number of past wins against this same opponent

2. Target Definitions

a) Match Winner

Predicts one of three outcomes, based on the home team’s result:

- **Home Win**
- **Away Win**
- **Draw**

b) Top Player by Disposals

The player with the **highest number of disposals** for their team in a match.

c) Top Player by Goals

The player with the **highest number of goals** for their team in a match.

3. Classification or Regression?

Match Winner = Classification

It’s classification, not regression, because the target is a **category** (Home Win / Away Win / Draw), not a number like a margin.

4. Feature Notes

The main model features are:

- win_streak
- last_5_avg_score
- head_to_head_wins

All three are based on **past matches only**, so the model never “sees” future results — this avoids data leakage.